



Returning home

As an artist looking for work, Leonardo was never sure where his next job might come from. That made it hard to truly settle in one place.

But Leonardo had lots of things to think about besides which patron had money to spend or which style of art was in fashion. In this case, it was international politics that led Leonardo to leave Milan around 1500, after living there for 17 years. Earlier the Duke of Milan, worried about being attacked by Venice and Naples,

had asked the French king, King Charles VIII, for support.

Charles was happy to have an excuse to invade Italy, so he agreed to step in.

